

especially those who have a large established business. If you have, say, a \$600-million business and you de-grow by 6-7 per cent, then you have to grow by \$50 million just to stay where you were. If you grow after that, [only] then you can achieve some kind of positive growth.

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What about emerging markets? What are your plans?

We have been consistently growing in the emerging markets in the past few years. And that business has now come very close to a billion dollars in terms of top line. It's also a profitable business. In some of the geographies like Romania and Sri Lanka, we have leadership position. The idea is that rather than focussing on all markets, we have identified six to seven countries in emerging markets where we want to find a way to continue to grow faster than the market.

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In the current environment, amidst the Ukraine war and Covid-19 impact, what are some of the biggest challenges that Sun Pharma has faced over the past three years? And what are the opportunities you are looking at?

The Russia-Ukraine conflict clearly disrupted the global economy. In the same way, Covid-19 also disrupted the global busi-

ness. What we are proud of is that we maintained a stable and consistent supply chain in spite of multiple challenges. Our team did a great job in ensuring consistent supply of our products to all markets. So, that allowed us to respond to the crisis. We could make many products that were urgently needed by patients even though they were not in our regular production schedule. I am happy that we could respond to the challenge and meet the needs of patients. Also, post Covid-19, multiple disruptions happened in the global supply chain because of the lifting of lockdowns and significant increase in costs leading to disruption in global transportation and so on. But I think we could manage proper availability of all our products.

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Sun Pharma is an important player in the global pharmaceuticals market. How do you see the industry evolving in the coming years and where do you see Sun Pharma?

The importance of good health and the ability of drugs to help patients lead as normal a life as possible and also the increase in life expectancy across the world means that drug consumption will continue to increase.

And that increases the importance of



IT [THE US] IS AN EXTREMELY COMPETITIVE MARKET WITH A LOT OF PRICING PRESSURE, AND IT CONTINUES TO CREATE CHALLENGES FOR ALL PLAYERS

competitive costs and high-quality products being available. I see a big opportunity for Indian companies, including Sun Pharma, to play an important role in the world as we continue to evolve.

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What is your company doing in R&D? What is your view on novel drugs? When do you think India can have its own novel drug?

Many Indian companies are working on novel

R&D, including Sun Pharma, as well as Sun Pharma Advanced Research Company (SPARC). So, hopefully, we should have a product in the market from an Indian company in the next few years. The role of innovation in the pharmaceuticals business is important and I think we have been successful in the generics business. We have to find a way to also succeed in innovative products. **BT**

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